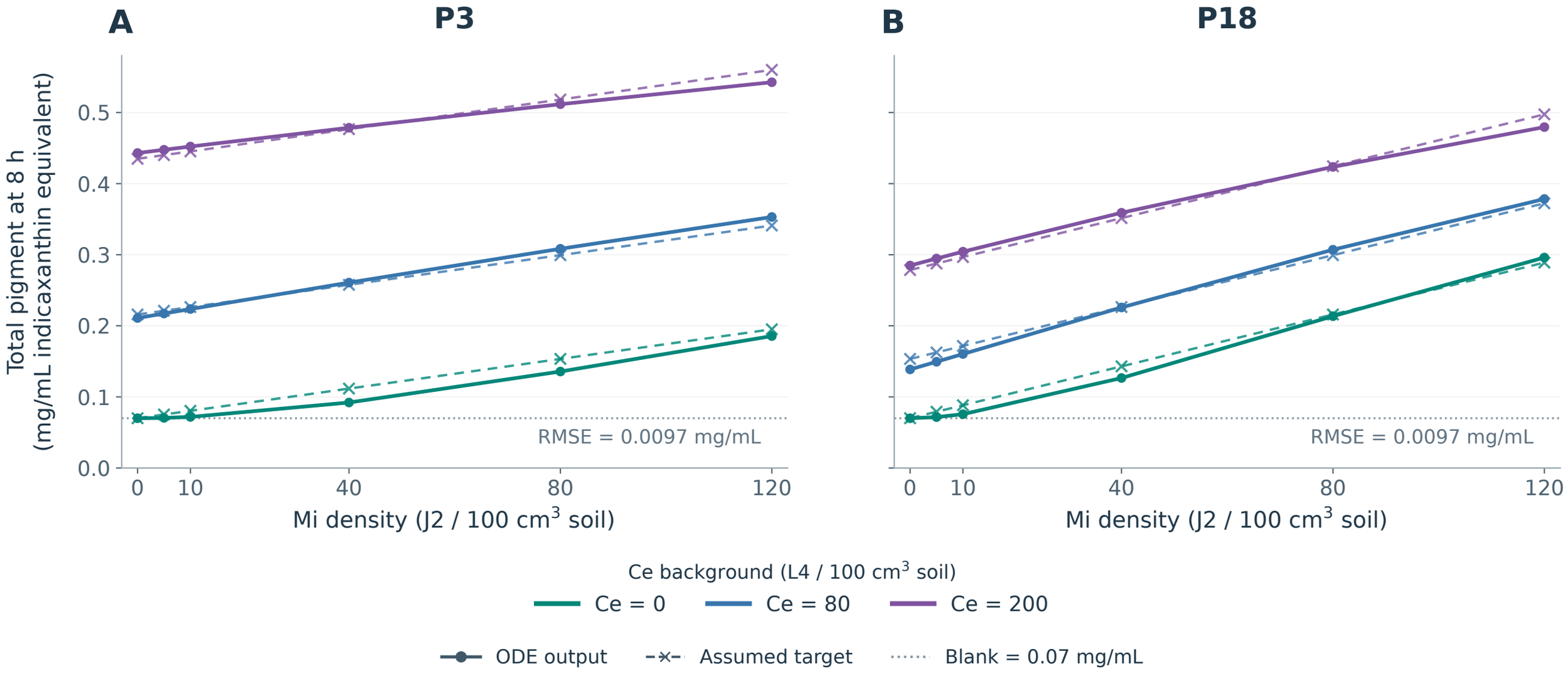ODE pigment response across background levels